

Salary Negotiation Scripts: Word-for-Word for Every Situation

RenWork Digital Products

1. Responding to an Initial Job Offer

****Opening Line:**** "Thank you for extending this offer. I am very excited about the opportunity to join the team and contribute to [Specific Project or Goal]. I've reviewed the details, and I'm eager to discuss the compensation package to ensure it aligns with the value I bring and my market expectations."

****The Pivot:**** "While I am thrilled about the role, the current number is slightly below the range I've been targeting based on my recent experience and the specific responsibilities we discussed during the interview process. I would like to explore if there is flexibility to adjust the base salary."

****The Ask:**** "Given the immediate impact I can make in [Specific Area], I would like to propose a base salary of \$[Target Amount]. This figure reflects the standard market rate for this level of expertise and accounts for the specialized skills I will bring to the table from day one."

****Objection Handling 1 (Budget Constraints):**** "I understand budget constraints are real. If the base salary cap is strict, could we discuss a signing bonus or an accelerated review process at the 6-month mark to adjust the compensation based on my performance?"

****Objection Handling 2 (Process Rigidity):**** "I appreciate that. Since I cannot move on the base salary at this stage, could we discuss the equity structure or the PTO allocation? I am flexible on those fronts if it helps bridge the gap to my total compensation target."

2. Counter-Offering Without Sounding Greedy

****Opening Line:**** "I value our ongoing partnership and want to ensure we are aligned on how my contributions are valued. I've been tracking my recent achievements, specifically [Achievement A] and [Achievement B], which directly resulted in [Revenue/Save] for the company."

****The Pivot:**** "These results were achieved while still operating within the scope of my previous title. As I take on increased responsibility for [New Responsibility], I believe a salary adjustment is necessary to reflect this expanded scope and the tangible ROI I am delivering."

****The Ask:**** "I am requesting a salary increase to \$[Target Amount]. This adjustment recognizes the heightened level of responsibility and the proven track record of success I've built over the last [Time Period]."

****Objection Handling 1 (Company Financials):**** "I hear you on the broader financial context. However, this request is not just about cost; it's about retention and continued high performance. By aligning my compensation with my output, we secure the momentum we've built. Can we look at a phased increase, starting with \$[Lower Target] now and a review in three months?"

****Objection Handling 2 (Peer Comparison):**** "I understand internal equity is important. I am not asking for more than my peers; I am asking for recognition of the specific, quantifiable results I've delivered that go beyond the standard role description. Let's focus on my individual impact rather than a comparative grid."

3. Asking for a Raise Mid-Year

****Opening Line:**** "I've scheduled this time to discuss my current role and look forward to the next phase of my growth here. I've really enjoyed tackling [Specific Challenge] recently, and I'd like to review my compensation in light of my recent contributions."

****The Pivot:**** "Since my last review, I have taken on [New Task/Project], which was not part of my original job description. This has required [Specific Skill/Effort] and has led to [Measurable Outcome]. I believe these additions warrant a reassessment of my current salary."

****The Ask:**** "Based on the expanded scope of my duties and the market data for similar roles with these additional responsibilities, I am requesting a salary increase to \$[Target Amount]."

****Objection Handling 1 (Timing):**** "I understand that mid-year raises are less common. However, the scope of my work has fundamentally changed since the last cycle. If a formal raise isn't possible due to policy, could we document the expanded job description and schedule a specific date for a compensation review in 90 days?"

****Objection Handling 2 (Performance Concerns):**** "I am confident in my performance, as evidenced by

[Metric/Result]. I am open to discussing any specific areas where you feel I haven't met expectations, but I believe the data supports the need for this adjustment. Let's focus on how we can structure this to meet both my needs and the company's goals."

4. Negotiating Freelance Project Rates

****Opening Line:**** "Thanks for the detailed brief. I've reviewed the scope, and I'm confident I can deliver the high-quality results you're looking for. Before we finalize the agreement, I'd like to align on the project fee."

****The Pivot:**** "Based on the complexity of [Specific Task] and the specialized expertise required for [Specific Skill], my standard rate for this type of engagement is higher than the initial estimate. I want to ensure the rate reflects the strategic value this project brings to your brand."

****The Ask:**** "For this project, which includes [Deliverable 1] and [Deliverable 2], I propose a total fee of \$[Target Amount]. This includes my standard deliverables plus a revision cycle to ensure we hit the mark."

****Objection Handling 1 (Budget Limit):**** "I understand budget is a factor. If \$[Target Amount] is outside the immediate budget, we could adjust the scope. For example, I could remove [Secondary Deliverable] to bring the cost down to \$[Lower Amount], but I would need to exclude that from the final deliverables."

****Objection Handling 2 (Competitor Quote):**** "I appreciate you sharing that. My rate reflects not just the hours, but the strategy, speed, and expertise I bring to the table. I can offer a 10% discount if we can agree to a faster turnaround time, which saves you administrative overhead and gets the project live sooner."

5. Asking for Equity

****Opening Line:**** "I am fully committed to the long-term success of [Company Name]. As we scale, I want to ensure my compensation structure reflects a true partnership with the company's future growth."

****The Pivot:**** "While the base salary is competitive, I am interested in aligning my long-term financial interests with the company's valuation. I believe holding equity will incentivize me to drive sustainable growth and stay invested in the company's mission beyond the current fiscal year."

****The Ask:**** "I would like to discuss adding an equity component to my compensation package. Specifically, I am looking for [Number] shares or options, with a standard four-year vesting schedule and a one-year cliff."

****Objection Handling 1 (Dilution Concerns):**** "I understand the concern regarding dilution. However, the equity I am requesting is a small percentage of the overall pool and is a standard ask for someone at this level. It signals my long-term commitment and reduces the risk of me leaving for a competitor with a better equity offer."

****Objection Handling 2 (Cash Flow):**** "If issuing new equity is difficult right now, could we discuss a phantom stock plan or a performance-based equity grant? This would allow the company to preserve cash flow while still providing me with a meaningful upside if we hit our upcoming milestones."

6. Negotiating Benefits and PTO

****Opening Line:**** "I'm very interested in the role and the culture. As I finalize my decision, I'd like to review the total compensation package, specifically the benefits and time-off policies, to ensure they fit my long-term planning."

****The Pivot:**** "I understand the base salary is fixed, but I find that flexibility in benefits is equally important for my productivity and well-being. I am looking for a package that supports a healthy work-life balance and long-term financial security."

****The Ask:**** "Could we discuss increasing the annual PTO to [Number] days? Additionally, I would appreciate a contribution toward [Specific Benefit, e.g., Home Office Setup or Health Insurance Premium], which would significantly improve my ability to focus and perform at my best."

****Objection Handling 1 (Standard Policy):**** "I know this is company standard. However, given my experience and the remote nature of the role, I believe a slight adjustment is fair. If the PTO days are fixed, could we offer a flexible work schedule or a one-time home office stipend of \$[Amount]?"

to
bridge the gap?"

****Objection Handling 2 (New Hire Status):**** "I understand new hires often start with standard packages. I am open to a 90-day review where we can revisit the PTO allocation based on my performance. This shows my confidence in my ability to deliver while allowing the company to mitigate risk."

7. Handling 'That Is Our Final Offer'

****Opening Line:**** "I appreciate your transparency. I value the opportunity and want to respect the decision you've made. However, I want to ensure that if we proceed, we are both comfortable with the terms to avoid any friction down the line."

****The Pivot:**** "If the base salary is truly non-negotiable, I would like to explore other levers in the compensation package that might bring the total value closer to my target. I am looking for a holistic solution that works for both of us."

****The Ask:**** "Could we add a \$[Amount] signing bonus? Alternatively, if the base is fixed, I would need a guaranteed performance review and potential raise at the 6-month mark if I meet [Specific KPI]. This